

Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRI) and Computed Tomography (CT) Scan – Site of Service Policy
Number: MP.13.16 Effective Date: March 1, 2025 Table of Contents Application

.....	1 Coverage Rationale	
.....	1 Medical Records Documentation Used for Reviews	2
Applicable Codes		2 Clinical Evidence
.....	6 References	
7 Policy History/Revision Information		7 Instructions for Use
.....	7 Application	Instructions for Use Page Related

Commercial/Individual Exchange Policies • Breast Imaging for Screening and Diagnosing Cancer •
Preventive Care Services UnitedHealthcare Commercial This Medical Policy applies to
UnitedHealthcare Commercial benefit plans, except UnitedHealthcare West benefit plans.

UnitedHealthcare Individual Exchange This Medical Policy applies to Individual Exchange benefit
plans in all states except for Colorado, Maryland, Texas, and Wisconsin. Coverage Rationale A
magnetic resonance imaging (MRI) or computed tomography (CT) imaging procedure in the hospital
outpatient department is considered medically necessary for individuals who meet any of the
following criteria: Under 18 years of age Require obstetrical observation Require perinatology
services Have a known allergy to a contrast agent used for the procedure Have a known chronic
disease undergoing active treatment, when direct comparison to prior studies requires the same
imaging protocol or equipment obtained at the same hospital-based facility where the procedure is
requested Have a systemic cancer on active treatment, when restaging studies require the same
imaging protocol or equipment used for prior studies obtained at the same hospital-based facility
where the procedure is requested Pre-procedure imaging which is done within 24 hours of the
interventional or surgical procedure and is an integral part of the planned procedure Are scheduled
for the MRI/CT imaging procedure within 24 hours of a hospital specialist appointment at the same
hospital-based facility where the procedure is requested Are participating in a clinical trial that
requires a specific imaging protocol or equipment not available in a freestanding facility An MRI/CT
imaging procedure in the hospital outpatient department is also considered medically necessary
when there are no geographically accessible appropriate alternative sites for the individual to
undergo the procedure, including but not limited to the following: Moderate or deep sedation or
general anesthesia is required for the procedure and freestanding facility providing such sedation is
not available; or Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRI) and Computed Tomography (CT) Scan – Site of
Service UnitedHealthcare Commercial and Individual Exchange Medical Policy Proprietary
Information of UnitedHealthcare. Copyright 2025 United HealthCare Services, Inc. Page 1 of 7
Effective 03/01/2025 The equipment for the size of the individual is not available; or Open MRI is
required because the member has a documented diagnosis of claustrophobia and/or severe anxiety
which is not available in a freestanding facility An MRI/CT imaging procedure in the hospital
outpatient department is considered medically necessary when imaging in a physician's office or
freestanding imaging center would reasonably be expected to delay care and adversely impact
health outcome. All other MRI/CT imaging procedures at a hospital-based imaging department or
facility are considered not medically necessary. This includes but is not limited to imaging for: Cancer
screening Initial diagnosis and/or initial staging for suspected or known cancer Surveillance of cancer
in remission with no clinical suspicion for change in disease status Non-cancerous musculoskeletal
conditions Note: Authorization is not required for procedures performed in an emergency room,
observation unit, urgent care center, or during an inpatient stay. Medical Records Documentation
Used for Reviews Benefit coverage for health services is determined by the member specific benefit
plan document and applicable laws that may require coverage for a specific service. Medical records
documentation may be required to assess whether the member meets the clinical criteria for
coverage but does not guarantee coverage of the service requested; refer to the protocol titled

Medical Records Documentation Used for Reviews. Applicable Codes The following list(s) of procedure and/or diagnosis codes is provided for reference purposes only and may not be all inclusive. Listing of a code in this policy does not imply that the service described by the code is a covered or non-covered health service. Benefit coverage for health services is determined by the member specific benefit plan document and applicable laws that may require coverage for a specific service. The inclusion of a code does not imply any right to reimbursement or guarantee claim payment. Other Policies and Guidelines may apply.

CPT Code Description

Computed Tomography

0042T Cerebral perfusion analysis using computed tomography with contrast administration, including post-processing of parametric maps with determination of cerebral blood flow, cerebral blood volume, and mean transit time

70450 70460 Computed tomography, head or brain; without contrast material

Computed tomography, head or brain; with contrast material(s)

70470 70480 Computed tomography, head or brain; without contrast material, followed by contrast material(s) and further sections

Computed tomography, orbit, sella, or posterior fossa or outer, middle, or inner ear; without contrast material

70481 Computed tomography, orbit, sella, or posterior fossa or outer, middle, or inner ear; with contrast material(s)

70482 Computed tomography, orbit, sella, or posterior fossa or outer, middle, or inner ear; without contrast material, followed by contrast material(s) and further sections

70486 70487 Computed tomography, maxillofacial area; without contrast material

Computed tomography, maxillofacial area; with contrast material(s)

70488 70490 Computed tomography, maxillofacial area; without contrast material, followed by contrast material(s) and further sections

Computed tomography, soft tissue neck; without contrast material

70491 Computed tomography, soft tissue neck; with contrast material(s)

Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRI) and Computed Tomography (CT) Scan – Site of Service

UnitedHealthcare Commercial and Individual Exchange Medical Policy

Proprietary Information of UnitedHealthcare. Copyright 2025 United HealthCare Services, Inc. Page 2 of 7 Effective 03/01/2025

Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRI) and Computed Tomography (CT) Scan – Site of Service Page 3 of 7 UnitedHealthcare Commercial and Individual Exchange Medical Policy Effective 03/01/2025

Proprietary Information of UnitedHealthcare. Copyright 2025 United HealthCare Services, Inc.

CPT Code Description

Computed Tomography

70492 Computed tomography, soft tissue neck; without contrast material followed by contrast material(s) and further sections

70496 Computed tomographic angiography, head, with contrast material(s), including noncontrast images, if performed, and image postprocessing

70498 Computed tomographic angiography, neck, with contrast material(s), including noncontrast images, if performed, and image postprocessing

71250 Computed tomography, thorax, diagnostic; without contrast material

71260 Computed tomography, thorax, diagnostic; with contrast material(s)

71270 Computed tomography, thorax, diagnostic; without contrast material, followed by contrast material(s) and further sections

71271 Computed tomography, thorax, low dose for lung cancer screening, without contrast material(s)

71275 Computed tomographic angiography, chest (noncoronary), with contrast material(s), including noncontrast images, if performed, and image postprocessing

72125 Computed tomography, cervical spine; without contrast material

72126 Computed tomography, cervical spine; with contrast material

72127 Computed tomography, cervical spine; without contrast material, followed by contrast material(s) and further sections

72128 Computed tomography, thoracic spine; without contrast material

72129 Computed tomography, thoracic spine; with contrast material

72130 Computed tomography, thoracic spine; without contrast material, followed by contrast material(s) and further sections

72131 Computed tomography, lumbar spine; without contrast material

72132 Computed tomography, lumbar spine; with contrast material

72133 Computed tomography, lumbar spine; without contrast material, followed by contrast material(s) and further sections

72191 Computed tomographic angiography, pelvis, with contrast material(s), including noncontrast images, if performed, and image postprocessing

72192 Computed tomography, pelvis; without contrast material

72193 Computed tomography, pelvis; with contrast

material(s) 72194 Computed tomography, pelvis; without contrast material, followed by contrast material(s) and further sections 73200 Computed tomography, upper extremity; without contrast material 73201 Computed tomography, upper extremity; with contrast material(s) 73202 Computed tomography, upper extremity; without contrast material, followed by contrast material(s) and further sections 73206 Computed tomographic angiography, upper extremity, with contrast material(s), including noncontrast images, if performed, and image postprocessing 73700 Computed tomography, lower extremity; without contrast material 73701 Computed tomography, lower extremity; with contrast material(s) 73702 Computed tomography, lower extremity; without contrast material, followed by contrast material(s) and further sections 73706 Computed tomographic angiography, lower extremity, with contrast material(s), including noncontrast images, if performed, and image postprocessing 74150 Computed tomography, abdomen; without contrast material 74160 Computed tomography, abdomen; with contrast material(s) 74170 Computed tomography, abdomen; without contrast material, followed by contrast material(s) and further sections Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRI) and Computed Tomography (CT) Scan – Site of Service Page 4 of 7 UnitedHealthcare Commercial and Individual Exchange Medical Policy Effective 03/01/2025 Proprietary Information of UnitedHealthcare. Copyright 2025 United HealthCare Services, Inc. CPT Code Description Computed Tomography 74174 Computed tomographic angiography, abdomen and pelvis, with contrast material(s), including noncontrast images, if performed, and image postprocessing 74175 Computed tomographic angiography, abdomen, with contrast material(s), including noncontrast images, if performed, and image postprocessing 74176 Computed tomography, abdomen and pelvis; without contrast material 74177 Computed tomography, abdomen and pelvis; with contrast material(s) 74178 Computed tomography, abdomen and pelvis; without contrast material in one or both body regions, followed by contrast material(s) and further sections in one or both body regions 74261 Computed tomographic (CT) colonography, diagnostic, including image postprocessing; without contrast material 74262 Computed tomographic (CT) colonography, diagnostic, including image postprocessing; with contrast material(s) including non-contrast images, if performed 74263 Computed tomographic (CT) colonography, screening, including image postprocessing 75571 Computed tomography, heart, without contrast material, with quantitative evaluation of coronary calcium 75572 Computed tomography, heart, with contrast material, for evaluation of cardiac structure and morphology (including 3D image postprocessing, assessment of cardiac function, and evaluation of venous structures, if performed) 75573 Computed tomography, heart, with contrast material, for evaluation of cardiac structure and morphology in the setting of congenital heart disease (including 3D image postprocessing, assessment of left ventricular [LV] cardiac function, right ventricular [RV] structure and function and evaluation of vascular structures, if performed) 75574 Computed tomographic angiography, heart, coronary arteries and bypass grafts (when present), with contrast material, including 3D image postprocessing (including evaluation of cardiac structure and morphology, assessment of cardiac function, and evaluation of venous structures, if performed) 75635 Computed tomographic angiography, abdominal aorta and bilateral iliofemoral lower extremity runoff, with contrast material(s), including noncontrast images, if performed, and image postprocessing 76380 Computed tomography, limited or localized follow-up study 76497 Unlisted computed tomography procedure (e.g., diagnostic, interventional) Magnetic Resonance Imaging 70336 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, temporomandibular joint(s) 70540 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, orbit, face, and/or neck; without contrast material(s) 70542 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, orbit, face, and/or neck; with contrast material(s) 70543 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, orbit, face, and/or neck; without contrast material(s), followed by contrast material(s) and further sequences 70544 Magnetic resonance angiography, head; without contrast material(s) 70545 Magnetic resonance angiography, head; with contrast material(s) 70546 Magnetic resonance angiography, head; without contrast

material(s), followed by contrast material(s) and further sequences 70547 Magnetic resonance angiography, neck; without contrast material(s) 70548 Magnetic resonance angiography, neck; with contrast material(s) 70549 Magnetic resonance angiography, neck; without contrast material(s), followed by contrast material(s) and further sequences 70551 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, brain (including brain stem); without contrast material 70552 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, brain (including brain stem); with contrast material(s) 70553 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, brain (including brain stem); without contrast material, followed by contrast material(s) and further sequences Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRI) and Computed Tomography (CT) Scan – Site of Service Page 5 of 7 UnitedHealthcare Commercial and Individual Exchange Medical Policy Effective 03/01/2025 Proprietary Information of UnitedHealthcare. Copyright 2025 United HealthCare Services, Inc. CPT Code Description Magnetic Resonance Imaging 70554 Magnetic resonance imaging, brain, functional MRI; including test selection and administration of repetitive body part movement and/or visual stimulation, not requiring physician or psychologist administration 70555 Magnetic resonance imaging, brain, functional MRI; requiring physician or psychologist administration of entire neurofunctional testing 71550 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, chest (e.g., for evaluation of hilar and mediastinal lymphadenopathy); without contrast material(s) 71551 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, chest (e.g., for evaluation of hilar and mediastinal lymphadenopathy); with contrast material(s) 71552 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, chest (e.g., for evaluation of hilar and mediastinal lymphadenopathy); without contrast material(s), followed by contrast material(s) and further sequences 71555 Magnetic resonance angiography, chest (excluding myocardium), with or without contrast material(s) 72141 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, spinal canal and contents, cervical; without contrast material 72142 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, spinal canal and contents, cervical; with contrast material(s) 72146 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, spinal canal and contents, thoracic; without contrast material 72147 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, spinal canal and contents, thoracic; with contrast material(s) 72148 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, spinal canal and contents, lumbar; without contrast material 72149 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, spinal canal and contents, lumbar; with contrast material(s) 72156 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, spinal canal and contents, without contrast material, followed by contrast material(s) and further sequences; cervical 72157 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, spinal canal and contents, without contrast material, followed by contrast material(s) and further sequences; thoracic 72158 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, spinal canal and contents, without contrast material, followed by contrast material(s) and further sequences; lumbar 72159 Magnetic resonance angiography, spinal canal and contents, with or without contrast material(s) 72195 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, pelvis; without contrast material(s) 72196 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, pelvis; with contrast material(s) 72197 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, pelvis; without contrast material(s), followed by contrast material(s) and further sequences 72198 Magnetic resonance angiography, pelvis, with or without contrast material(s) 73218 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, upper extremity, other than joint; without contrast material(s) 73219 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, upper extremity, other than joint; with contrast material(s) 73220 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, upper extremity, other than joint; without contrast material(s), followed by contrast material(s) and further sequences 73221 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, any joint of upper extremity; without contrast material(s) 73222 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, any joint of upper extremity; with contrast material(s) 73223 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, any joint of upper extremity; without contrast material(s), followed by contrast material(s) and further sequences 73225 Magnetic resonance angiography, upper extremity, with or without contrast material(s) Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRI) and Computed Tomography (CT) Scan – Site

of Service Page 6 of 7 UnitedHealthcare Commercial and Individual Exchange Medical Policy Effective 03/01/2025 Proprietary Information of UnitedHealthcare. Copyright 2025 United HealthCare Services, Inc. CPT Code Description Magnetic Resonance Imaging 73718 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, lower extremity other than joint; without contrast material(s) 73719 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, lower extremity other than joint; with contrast material(s) 73720 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, lower extremity other than joint; without contrast material(s), followed by contrast material(s) and further sequences 73721 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, any joint of lower extremity; without contrast material 73722 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, any joint of lower extremity; with contrast material(s) 73723 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, any joint of lower extremity; without contrast material(s), followed by contrast material(s) and further sequences 73725 Magnetic resonance angiography, lower extremity, with or without contrast material(s) 74181 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, abdomen; without contrast material(s) 74182 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, abdomen; with contrast material(s) 74183 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, abdomen; without contrast material(s), followed by with contrast material(s) and further sequences 74185 Magnetic resonance angiography, abdomen, with or without contrast material(s) 75557 Cardiac magnetic resonance imaging for morphology and function without contrast material 75559 Cardiac magnetic resonance imaging for morphology and function without contrast material; with stress imaging 75561 Cardiac magnetic resonance imaging for morphology and function without contrast material(s), followed by contrast material(s) and further sequences; 75563 Cardiac magnetic resonance imaging for morphology and function without contrast material(s), followed by contrast material(s) and further sequences; with stress imaging 76390 Magnetic resonance spectroscopy 76498 Unlisted magnetic resonance procedure (e.g., diagnostic, interventional) 77046 Magnetic resonance imaging, breast, without contrast material; unilateral 77047 Magnetic resonance imaging, breast, without contrast material; bilateral 77048 Magnetic resonance imaging, breast, without and with contrast material(s), including computer aided detection (CAD real-time lesion detection, characterization and pharmacokinetic analysis), when performed; unilateral 77049 Magnetic resonance imaging, breast, without and with contrast material(s), including computer aided detection (CAD real-time lesion detection, characterization and pharmacokinetic analysis), when performed; bilateral 77084 Magnetic resonance (e.g., proton) imaging, bone marrow blood supply

CPT® is a registered trademark of the American Medical Association HCPCS Code Description Magnetic Resonance Imaging S8037 Magnetic resonance cholangiopancreatography (MRCP) Clinical Evidence American College of Obstetricians and Gynecologists (ACOG) ACOG's Committee on Obstetric Practice makes the following recommendations regarding diagnostic imaging procedures during pregnancy and lactation: Ultrasonography and magnetic resonance imaging (MRI) are not associated with risk and are the imaging techniques of choice for the pregnant patient, but they should be used prudently and only when use is expected to answer a relevant clinical question Radiation exposure through radiography, computed tomography (CT) scan, or nuclear medicine imaging techniques is at a dose much lower than the exposure associated with fetal harm The use of gadolinium contrast with MRI should be limited; it may be used as a contrast agent only if it significantly improves diagnostic performance and is expected to improve fetal or maternal outcome (ACOG, 2021) American Society of Anesthesiologists (ASA) The 2015 ASA Practice Advisory on Anesthetic Care for Magnetic Resonance Imaging states that risks related to the patient may include age-related risks, health-related risks, and risks from foreign bodies located in or on the patient or implanted ferromagnetic items. Age-related risks apply to neonates or premature infants and the elderly Health-related risks include, but are not limited to:

- o Need for intensive or critical care
- o Impaired respiratory function (e.g., tonsillar hypertrophy and sleep apnea)
- o Changes in level of sedation, muscle relaxation, or ventilation
- o Hemodynamic instability and vasoactive infusion

requirements o Comorbidities that may contribute to adverse MRI effects (e.g., burns or temperature increases in patients with obesity or peripheral vascular disease) Foreign bodies include nonmedical ferromagnetic items imbedded in the patient (e.g., eyeliner tattoos) or attached to the patient (e.g., pierced jewelry; implanted ferromagnetic items may include items such as aneurysm clips, prosthetic heart valves, or coronary arterial stents References American College of Obstetricians and Gynecologists. Committee opinion 723: Guidelines for diagnostic imaging during pregnancy and lactation. VOL. 130, NO. 4. October 2017. Reaffirmed October 2021. American Society of Anesthesiologists. Practice Advisory on anesthetic care for magnetic resonance imaging. Anesthesiology. V 122; No 3. March 2015. Policy History/Revision Information Date Summary of Changes 03/01/2025 Applicable Codes Computed Tomography Added CPT code 0042T Supporting Information Archived previous policy version MP.13.15 Instructions for Use This Medical Policy provides assistance in interpreting UnitedHealthcare standard benefit plans. When deciding coverage, the member specific benefit plan document must be referenced as the terms of the member specific benefit plan may differ from the standard plan. In the event of a conflict, the member specific benefit plan document governs. Before using this policy, please check the member specific benefit plan document and any applicable federal or state mandates. UnitedHealthcare reserves the right to modify its Policies and Guidelines as necessary. This Medical Policy is provided for informational purposes. It does not constitute medical advice. This Medical Policy may also be applied to Medicare Advantage plans in certain instances. In the absence of a Medicare National Coverage Determination (NCD), Local Coverage Determination (LCD), or other Medicare coverage guidance, CMS allows a Medicare Advantage Organization (MAO) to create its own coverage determinations, using objective evidence-based rationale relying on authoritative evidence (Medicare IOM Pub. No. 100-16, Ch. 4, §90.5). UnitedHealthcare may also use tools developed by third parties, such as the InterQual® criteria, to assist us in administering health benefits. UnitedHealthcare Medical Policies are intended to be used in connection with the independent professional medical judgment of a qualified health care provider and do not constitute the practice of medicine or medical advice. Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRI) and Computed Tomography (CT) Scan – Site of Service UnitedHealthcare Commercial and Individual Exchange Medical Policy Proprietary Information of UnitedHealthcare. Copyright 2025 United HealthCare Services, Inc.